

Dusting SOP

The Cleaning CEO Blueprint — 100% Cleaner Academy

Applies to: All services — regular, deep, move-out, STR

Time target: Regular 5–10 min/room | Deep 15–20 min/room (includes fans, vents, baseboards)

Purpose

Dusting removes allergens and gives rooms a polished look. Always work **top to bottom** so falling dust lands on surfaces you haven't cleaned yet. Use dry microfiber first; damp only when needed.

Supplies

- ☐ Microfiber cloths (dry — 2 per room minimum)
 - ☐ Extendable duster (ceiling fans, high corners)
 - ☐ Lambswool or microfiber duster (fragile items)
 - ☐ Step stool (safe, non-slip)
 - ☐ Vacuum with brush attachment (vents, upholstery edges)
 - ☐ Furniture polish (wood only — sparingly, if client requests)
 - ☐ Glass cleaner (for framed art glass only)
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Top-to-Bottom Dusting Order

In every room, follow this sequence:

1. ☐ Ceiling corners and cobwebs
2. ☐ Ceiling fans and light fixtures
3. ☐ Vents and return air grilles
4. ☐ Top of door frames and window frames
5. ☐ Wall art, mirrors, clocks (dry dust frame first)
6. ☐ Shelves — top shelf down, back to front
7. ☐ Furniture surfaces (dressers, nightstands, TV stands)
8. ☐ Lamps, décor, electronics (dry dust only on screens)

9. ☐ Chair rails, window sills
 10. ☐ Baseboards (see Deep Clean SOP for damp-wipe)
 11. ☐ Floor vacuum (captures fallen dust)
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Microfiber Technique

The 8-fold method — maximize one cloth per room:

- ☐ Fold cloth into quarters (8 usable sides)
- ☐ Use one clean side per surface type or zone
- ☐ Flip to fresh side when cloth looks gray or feels damp
- ☐ Never reuse a bathroom cloth in living areas
- ☐ Shake cloth outside or into trash between rooms — don't spread dust indoors

Dry dusting: Default for all surfaces. Captures dust without streaking.

Damp dusting: Lightly mist cloth with all-purpose cleaner for sticky surfaces (kitchen shelves, TV stands with grease). Wring nearly dry.

Ceiling Fans

Regular clean: Wipe accessible blades with damp microfiber on extendable duster.

Deep clean / add-on (+\$10 each):

- ☐ Turn fan OFF — verify switch, not just remote
- ☐ Place sheet or towel under fan to catch debris
- ☐ Dust blade tops first (where dust hides), then bottoms
- ☐ Wipe motor housing
- ☐ Wipe pull chains and light fixture
- ☐ Vacuum fallen dust from floor below

Do NOT spin blades dry — spreads dust everywhere.

Vents & Return Grilles

- ☐ Vacuum with brush attachment first (loosens dust)

- ☐ Wipe slats with damp microfiber wrapped around knife (protected) or vent brush
 - ☐ Do not remove vent covers unless in move-out scope and you can reinstall
 - ☐ Deep clean: wipe wall surrounding vent (dust halo)
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Electronics & Fragile Items

- ☐ TV screens: dry microfiber only — no spray directly on screen
 - ☐ Dust remotes, game controllers (high-touch — disinfect if client requests)
 - ☐ Pick up and dust **under** small items, then replace exactly where found
 - ☐ Do not dust collections of fragile valuables without moving carefully one at a time
 - ☐ Never spray polish on electronics
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Blinds & Window Treatments

- ☐ Close blinds; dust each slat top to bottom with damp cloth or blind duster
 - ☐ Reverse direction; dust other side
 - ☐ Curtains: vacuum with upholstery attachment (light touch)
 - ☐ Do not wash curtains unless explicit add-on
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Furniture & Wood Surfaces

- ☐ Dust with dry microfiber following wood grain
 - ☐ Polish only if client requests and product is approved (avoid buildup on regular cleans)
 - ☐ Lift items to dust underneath — photo placement if valuable
 - ☐ Don't dust around clutter piles — straighten lightly, dust, replace
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High-Touch Points (Include in Every Dust Pass)

- ☐ Door handles and knobs
 - ☐ Light switches and switch plates
 - ☐ Handrails on stairs
 - ☐ Cabinet handles (kitchen and bath)
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Quality Standards

Dusting passes when:

- ☐ No visible dust on surfaces at normal viewing height
 - ☐ Ceiling fan blades show no fuzzy buildup (deep clean)
 - ☐ Vents are not gray with dust halo
 - ☐ Shelves pass the "white glove swipe" on deep cleans
 - ☐ No streaks on wood or glass from damp dusting
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Do NOT (Dusting)

- **✗** Dust bottom to top — you'll redo everything
 - **✗** Use feather dusters as primary tool — they spread dust
 - **✗** Spray furniture polish on every surface every visit — creates waxy buildup
 - **✗** Climb unstable furniture to reach fans — use proper step stool
 - **✗** Dust computer keyboards with wet cloth
 - **✗** Move framed photos without supporting both sides
 - **✗** Ignore cobwebs in ceiling corners — clients see them from the couch
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Time-Saving Tips for Field Teams

- Carry extendable duster on shoulder between rooms — hit fans and corners first in every room before surface work
 - One dry cloth + one damp cloth per caddy — swap per room
 - Deep clean day: dust entire home before any wet work begins
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100% Cleaner — Dust top to bottom. Every room. Every time.